TrimNova Marketplace (Version 4.0) — Executive Guide to How the Platform Works

Prepared for the Managing Director | Plain-English Functional Walkthrough (Based Strictly on Scope Baseline V4.0)

1. Executive Summary: What Changed in Version 4.0?

In our previous model (Version 2.0), TrimNova acted like a traditional middleman trader: customers bought from TrimNova, our team manually picked a supplier behind the scenes, goods came to our warehouse first, and we paid suppliers through standard accounts payable.

Under the new Version 4.0 Marketplace Model, TrimNova operates as a controlled B2B marketplace—similar to how Amazon or Flipkart works for business buyers, but tailored for garment trims with strict quality, pricing, and payout controls.

The 5 Golden Rules of the New Marketplace

- **Customers buy directly from approved vendors** through the TrimNova website (the vendor's name and verified certificates are visible to the buyer).
- **Vendors upload their own products and prices**, while our Admin team approves every product before it can be seen or bought by a customer.
- **Admin controls the platform margin (commission)** on each product before it goes live, and that percentage is locked the moment an order is placed.
- **Vendors process and ship their own orders** directly to the customer (with an optional TrimNova micro-warehouse service called *TrimInsta* for fast dispatch).
- **Admin releases payment to the vendor only after the customer's return period is completely over** and no return or dispute is open.

2. How Each Login Works: Who Does What on the Website?

To prevent mistakes and fraud, the website separates users into distinct logins. Nobody can see data that does not belong to them, and no single person can both prepare and approve a vendor bank payout.

Summary Table of Logins and Access Rights

Login / Role	Who Uses It	How Account is Created	Core Everyday Responsibilities	What They Are Blocked From Doing
1. Vendor Login	Trim suppliers & manufacturers	Self-registration on website + Email OTP + Approver sign-off	Upload KYC/certificates, list products & stock, accept orders, generate tax invoices, pack & ship goods, inspect returns, view earnings statements	Cannot publish products without Admin approval; cannot change agreed commission %; cannot see other vendors' orders or rates
2. Customer Login	Garment factories & buyers	Self-registration on website + Email OTP verification	Browse & compare trims across 12 categories, check volume discounts, pay online, track parcels, download vendor tax invoices, request returns/replacements	Cannot see vendor bank details, private KYC documents, or the platform's commission rate
3. Approver Login	Internal Compliance & Catalogue Reviewers	Invitation-only by Super Admin (no public sign-up)	Verify vendor GSTIN, PAN, bank details, and textile certificates; review submitted product listings; approve, reject (with reasons), or place on hold	Cannot set commercial commission rates or release bank payouts to vendors
4. Commercial & Super Admin Login	Internal Commercial Managers & Platform Owners	Invitation-only with two-factor authentication (MFA)	Set product-wise commission %, publish listings, manage the 12 product categories, generate single-use discount coupons, oversee SLA delays & exceptions	Cannot bypass the post-return-period payout rule or delete completed financial records

Login / Role	Who Uses It	How Account is Created	Core Everyday Responsibilities	What They Are Blocked From Doing
5. Support & Operations Login	Internal Customer/Vendor Helpdesk Team	Invitation-only staff role with MFA	Handle order cancellations, delivery failures, and customer return/replacement cases; mediate disputes between buyers and vendors	Cannot mark a bank payout as paid or alter historical invoices
6. Finance Login (Preparer & Approver)	Internal Finance & Accounts Team	Invitation-only with MFA (split into two separate people: Preparer and Approver)	Reconcile payment gateway collections, prepare vendor settlement batches after return windows close, independently approve payouts, issue commission invoices	One person cannot both prepare and approve the same vendor payout batch

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Login 1: The Vendor Login (For Trim Suppliers)

When a trim manufacturer or supplier logs into the Vendor Portal, here is everything they do step by step:

- **Step 1 — Sign-Up & Identity Verification:**
  - The vendor registers with their email, user ID, and phone number, and verifies their email using a 6-digit One-Time Password (OTP, valid for 10 minutes with up to 5 attempts).
  - For India, the vendor enters their business details, bank account, **GSTIN**, and **PAN**. The system automatically checks their GSTIN (to pull their legal company name) and verifies their PAN status via verification APIs (required for tax deduction / TDS compliance).
  - The vendor uploads their textile and packaging quality certificates (such as environmental or safety certificates) with issue and expiry dates.
  - Until our Approver team verifies all documents and bank details, the vendor can save their profile draft, but **the system blocks them from publishing any products or receiving orders**.

- **Step 2 — Choosing Membership Plans & Optional Warehouse Space (If Enabled):**
    - If the paid membership module is turned on, the vendor pays a one-time registration fee and selects a plan (**Elite**, **Gold**, or **Basic**). They can also enter a single-use discount coupon code given by Admin.
    - Regardless of whether a vendor's plan expires later, they always keep access to fulfil existing paid orders and download their financial statements.
    - If the optional **TrimInsta (Warehouse)** module is turned on, the vendor can request warehouse floor space (in square feet) at a TrimNova hub to store fast-moving stock.
- **Step 3 — Adding Products & Updating Stock:**
    - The vendor selects from TrimNova's **12 approved product categories** (covering 500+ products and 685+ estimated variant SKUs) and enters product specifications, photos, Minimum Order Quantities (MOQ), volume price tiers, tax rates, dispatch lead times, and stock levels.
    - They can add products one by one or upload a bulk spreadsheet template.
    - Once a product is live, the vendor can update routine **ready-stock quantities** anytime without waiting for re-approval. However, if they change the **price, product specs, photos, certificates, or delivery promise**, the system sends that change for Admin review while keeping the previously approved version live.
    - The vendor can see the platform commission percentage that Admin has set for each of their products as **read-only**—they cannot edit it.
- **Step 4 — Processing Customer Orders:**
    - When a customer pays for an order, the vendor receives only **their portion of the order** (their "sub-order") in their inbox.
    - The vendor must **Accept or Reject** the order within the agreed time limit (proposed default: **1 business day**). If they reject an item, that item is cancelled and refunded to the customer—it is never secretly passed to another vendor.
    - Once accepted, the vendor moves the order through clear stages: *Allocated → In Preparation/Production → Quality Check (QC) Complete → Packed → Ready for Dispatch*.
    - Before handing the parcel to the courier, the vendor generates the **Seller-to-Customer Tax Invoice**, enters package weight/dimensions, and books the shipment. They can also ship an order in multiple partial lots if needed.

- **Step 5 — Handling Returns & Checking Payout Statements:**
    - If a customer raises a return request, the vendor reviews the request, receives the returned goods back, inspects the condition (recording photos and quantities), and marks whether the return is accepted or disputed.
    - In their finance dashboard, the vendor sees a transparent statement showing:
        - **Held Balance:** Money from delivered orders that are still inside the customer return window or have an open return/dispute.
        - **Eligible Balance:** Money that has cleared the return window and is ready for the next payout batch.
        - **Paid Balance:** Completed bank transfers with bank reference numbers and downloadable commission invoices.

Login 2: The Customer Login (For Garment Factories & Buyers)

When a garment factory or buyer logs into the **Customer Portal**, the experience is designed to be as simple as online shopping while supporting bulk B2B needs:

- **Sign-Up & Business Profile:**
    - Buyers register with email OTP verification and save their company name, GST/tax details (for B2B invoicing), billing address, and multiple factory delivery addresses.
- **Searching, Filtering & Comparing Trims:**
    - Buyers can search across all **12 Trim Categories** by keyword or SKU, and filter by vendor, material, colour, size, certification, unit of measure (pieces, metres, rolls, cones, kg), and delivery availability.
    - On every product page, the buyer clearly sees:
        - The **approved vendor's name** and return policy.
        - **Volume price tiers** (lower per-unit price when buying larger quantities) and Minimum Order Quantities (MOQ).
        - **Certification logos** in two visual states: **Active/Clickable** (for valid, approved certificates held by that vendor, which open a safe public copy when clicked) and **Greyed-out/Disabled** (for certificates the vendor does not hold). For vendors on the **Basic Plan**, the certification logo section is hidden completely.

        - **Delivery options:** Standard **Online** delivery (shipped from the vendor's factory) or **Insta** fast delivery (shipped from a TrimNova hub, which automatically turns off if hub stock hits zero).
- **Multi-Vendor Cart & Checkout:**
    - A buyer can add trims from multiple vendors into **one shopping cart** and pay in **one single checkout**.
    - The cart clearly groups items by vendor and warns the buyer that different vendors may ship in separate parcels with separate tax invoices and delivery dates.
    - When the buyer clicks pay, the system **reserves the exact stock for 15 minutes** so no one else can buy the last units while payment is processing.
- **Tracking, Invoices & Easy Reordering:**
    - Once payment succeeds, one **Parent Order** is created for the customer, and the system automatically splits it into separate **Vendor Sub-Orders** behind the scenes.
    - From their dashboard, the buyer tracks each parcel live, downloads the official **Seller Tax Invoice** for each vendor, and can click **Reorder** on past purchases (which refreshes the quote with current prices and stock).
- **Cancellations, Returns & Replacements:**
    - Before a vendor accepts an order, the buyer can cancel unshipped items directly. After vendor acceptance (but before dispatch), cancellation requests go to the vendor/support for approval.
    - Once a parcel is marked **Delivered**, the customer dashboard shows the **exact date and time when the return window expires** for that specific delivery lot.
    - If items are defective, wrong, or eligible for return, the buyer selects the exact delivered lot and quantity, uploads photo evidence, and chooses either a **Refund** or a **Replacement**.

Login 3: The Approver Login (Compliance & Catalogue Quality Gatekeeper)

Approvers are internal staff members invited by Admin (nobody can self-register as an Approver from the public website). Their job is to protect marketplace quality before anything reaches a customer:

- **Vendor KYC & Certificate Verification Queue:**
    - Reviews new vendor applications, checking automated GSTIN and PAN verification results (and manually reviewing any mismatches or API outages).
    - Inspects every uploaded textile or packaging certificate and marks each document as **Approved**, **Rejected** (with mandatory written comments explaining what to fix), or **On Hold** (requesting clarification).
    - Verifies any changes a vendor makes to their bank account before money can be sent to the new account.
    - **Target Review Speed:** Proposed default target is **2 business days**, with a queue showing how long each submission has been waiting.
- **Product Content & Specification Review:**
    - Whenever an active vendor submits a new product (or edits an existing product's price, specs, or photos), the system sends a **simultaneous dual notification** to both the **Approver** and the **Commercial Admin**.
    - The Approver checks the product title, variant attributes, unit conversions, photos, and linked certificates.
    - Even after the Approver marks a product **Content Approved**, the product **still cannot go live** until the Commercial Admin sets and approves the platform margin (commission %).

Login 4: The Commercial & Super Admin Login (Platform Control Tower)

This login is used by senior management and commercial leads (protected by Multi-Factor Authentication) to govern pricing, categories, and daily operations:

- **Setting Product-Wise Margin (Commission %):**
    - For every submitted product (and optionally for individual variants), Commercial Admin sets the agreed **platform commission percentage** to be deducted from the vendor's sales.
    - Only when **both** the Approver's content check and the Commercial Admin's margin percentage are approved can the product be published to the live website.

    - If Admin changes a product's commission rate later, the new rate applies **only to future orders**—any order already placed keeps the exact commission rate that was frozen at checkout.
- **Managing the 12 Product Categories & Rules:**
    - Maintains the master list of **12 Trim Categories** (Labels & Tags, Threads & Yarns, Buttons & Fasteners, Zippers, Tapes & Ribbons, Interlining & Fusing, Packaging, Embellishments, Elastics & Cords, Buckles & Hardware, Velcro & Closures, and Safety & Compliance), along with mandatory attributes and units of measure.
- **Creating Discount Coupons & Managing Plans:**
    - Generates **single-use coupon codes** that vendors can use when paying for registration or membership plans, as well as promotional customer coupons.
    - Distinguishes between **Vendor-Funded Discounts** (which reduce the vendor's selling price) and **Platform-Funded Coupons** (where TrimNova funds the discount so the vendor still receives their full agreed earnings).
- **Monitoring SLA Breaches & Emergency Controls:**
    - Monitors a live dashboard of overdue vendor order acceptances, late dispatches, failed deliveries, and expiring vendor certificates (when a required certificate expires, the system automatically hides the badge and blocks new sales where required).
    - Can immediately unpublish a product or suspend a vendor if a compliance or quality risk arises, while keeping a supervised path open for the vendor to finish or refund already-paid orders.
    - Any action an Admin takes on behalf of a vendor is permanently logged in the audit trail with the staff member's name, reason, and before/after values.

Login 5: The Support & Operations Login (Customer Care & Dispute Resolution)

Support staff have a dedicated view to keep orders moving smoothly and resolve problems fairly:

- **Single Support Channel for Buyers:**

    - Even if a customer's order involves three different vendors, the customer only deals with one TrimNova support channel. Support tickets are scoped so Vendor A never sees Vendor B's details.
- **Managing Delivery Exceptions & Cancellations:**
    - Handles failed deliveries (Non-Delivery Reports / NDR), address corrections before packing, courier lost/damaged claims, and Return-to-Origin (RTO) cases.
- **Adjudicating Return & Replacement Disputes:**
    - If a vendor fails to respond to a customer return request within the 2-business-day target, or if a vendor and customer disagree on the condition or quantity of returned goods, Support steps in to review photo evidence and make the final decision.
    - Support can approve a customer **Refund** or **Replacement** once verified, which then routes to Finance for execution.

Login 6: The Finance Login (Two-Person Payout & Accounting Control)

To give the Managing Director complete financial peace of mind, the Finance portal enforces a **strict two-person rule (Separation of Duties)** and an **automatic return-window lock**:

- **Why Vendor Money Cannot Be Paid Early (The Non-Negotiable Gate):**
    - When a customer pays at checkout, TrimNova collects the money. However, the vendor's earnings are immediately placed in a **Return Window Hold**.
    - An automated system evaluator checks every delivered lot against **6 strict conditions** before a single rupee becomes **Eligible** for payout:
        i. The parcel is confirmed **Delivered** with verified proof of delivery (a vendor cannot simply click "Delivered" without courier proof).
        ii. The **Customer Return Policy Window has completely expired** (for example, if delivered on 1 November at 10:00 AM with a 10-day return window, it only becomes eligible strictly after 11 November at 10:00 AM).
        iii. The customer's payment is **captured and reconciled** with the payment gateway.
        iv. Both the **Seller Invoice** and **Platform Commission Invoice** are valid.

v. There are **zero open return, replacement, refund, or chargeback cases** on those units.
vi. The vendor's **bank account is verified and approved**.

- **Role A — Finance Preparer:**
  - Reviews all units that have passed the return deadline and creates a **Settlement Draft Batch** showing the gross sale, commission deducted, taxes on commission, any statutory tax withholding (TDS), refund adjustments, and the final **Net Vendor Payable**.
- **Role B — Finance Approver (Must Be a Different Person):**
  - Independently reviews and approves the exact settlement draft. If anyone changes a single line or rupee amount in the draft, the approval is automatically cancelled and must be re-approved.
  - Right before executing the bank transfer, the system re-checks that no new return or bank account change happened in the meantime.
  - Payouts are marked **Paid** only after the bank confirms success (never just because a file was sent), preventing duplicate transfers if a bank connection times out.

3. Simple Worked Examples: How the Money Flows

Below are plain-English examples (using Rs 100 per unit, 10% platform commission, and a 10-day return window from Section 19 & 20 of the V4.0 document, excluding taxes/shipping for simplicity) showing how the system calculates vendor payouts in different real-world situations:

Business Scenario	What Happens	Customer Pays	Platform Commission (10%)	Net Paid to Vendor	When Is Vendor Paid?
1. Normal Sale (100 units @ Rs 100)	Delivered on 1 Nov; no returns raised	Rs 10,000	Rs 1,000	**Rs 9,000**	Held until 11 Nov; paid aft...
2. Vendor-Funded Discount (Rs 1,000 off)	Vendor offers a Rs 1,000 discount; commission is calculated on Rs 9,000	Rs 9,000	Rs 900	**Rs 8,100**	After return window ends

Business Scenario	What Happens	Customer Pays	Platform Commission (10%)	Net Paid to Vendor	When Is Vendor Paid?
3. Platform Promo Coupon (Rs 500 off)	TrimNova gives buyer a Rs 500 coupon; vendor is not penalized for platform promo	Rs 9,500	Rs 1,000 (less Rs 500 promo cost = Rs 500 net to platform)	**Rs 9,000**	After return window ends
4. Partial Return (20 of 100 units returned)	Buyer returns 20 units (Rs 2,000 refunded) and keeps 80 units	Rs 10,000 (Refunded Rs 2,000 = Rs 8,000 net)	Rs 800 (Rs 200 reversed on returned units)	**Rs 7,200**	Paid on the 80 kept units ...
5. Multi-Vendor Order (Vendor A + Vendor B)	Buyer orders from both; Vendor B has a return dispute, Vendor A has none	Combined checkout	Calculated per vendor	**Vendor A paid on time**; only Vendor B's disputed amount is held	Vendor A is never delayed...
6. Late Defect After Payout	Vendor was already paid Rs 9,000, then an exceptional 20-unit defect refund (Rs 2,000) is approved	Refunded Rs 2,000	Rs 200 reversed	**Rs 1,800 recovery debit** posted to vendor's next statement	Past payout record stays ...

4. Optional Modules (Can Be Turned On at Launch or in Phase 2)

The V4.0 document separates the **Core Marketplace** from **Optional Modules** so the business can launch cleanly and activate extras when ready:

- **Vendor Registration Fee & Membership Plans (Elite, Gold, Basic):**
  - *Elite Plan:* Includes marketing support, verified stamp (subject to passing compliance checks), certification logo visibility, and analytics dashboard.
  - *Gold Plan:* Includes verified stamp, certification logo visibility, and dashboard.
  - *Basic Plan:* Entry-level listing with no verification stamp and the certification logo section hidden on product pages.
  - *Note:* In the V4.0 document, plan prices are currently marked as `Rs 00` placeholders awaiting your commercial sign-off.
- **TrimInsta (Platform Micro-Warehouse & Fast Delivery):**
  - Vendors can rent square footage in a TrimNova hub. When hub stock for a SKU drops **below 50 units**, the system automatically emails the vendor to restock. When hub stock hits **0 units**, the "Insta" delivery option is immediately disabled

on the product page while normal delivery from the vendor's factory stays active.

- **Custom-Made Trims & Artwork Proof Approval:**
    - Allows buyers to upload custom brand artwork/logos and approve a digital proof before the vendor starts manufacturing. Custom items block ordinary "change-of-mind" returns but still protect the buyer if the item is defective or doesn't match the approved proof.
- **Cash on Delivery (COD), Customer Subscriptions & Paid Ads:**
    - Built as separate gated switches. If COD is enabled later, a vendor cannot be paid until the courier actually deposits the collected cash with TrimNova.

5. Delivery Plan & Key Decisions Needed from the Managing Director

The technical build is organized into **8 Work Packages (WP01 to WP08)**—starting with Foundation & KYC (WP01–WP02), Catalogue & Checkout (WP03–WP04), Fulfilment & Returns (WP05–WP06), Finance & Settlement (WP07), and Migration & 48 Mandatory Testing Gates (WP08).

Before the technical team locks the final configuration, Section 35 of the V4.0 document lists 15 business decisions (D01–D15) for leadership sign-off. The most important ones for the Managing Director are:

- **Brand & Legal Entity Name (`D01` & `D15`):** Confirm "TrimNova" as the official portal brand and confirm the exact legal company name to print on vendor contracts, customer invoices, and platform commission invoices.
- **Commission vs. Markup Model (`D02` & `D03`):** Confirm the recommended commission model (where the vendor sets the selling price and Admin deducts an agreed percentage, rather than adding a markup on top).
- **Membership Plan Prices & TrimInsta Launch Scope (`D04` & `D13`):** Decide the actual rupee prices for the Registration Fee and Elite/Gold/Basic plans (replacing the `Rs 00` placeholders) and whether TrimInsta warehousing launches on Day 1 or in Phase 2.
- **Return Window Days & Service Timers (`D05`, `D06` & `D12`):** Confirm the return policy duration by category (10 calendar days is the proposed example) and confirm the

operational timers (1 business day for vendors to accept orders; 2 business days for staff to review certificates and returns).

- **Payout Schedule, Tax Withholding & Old Order Cutover (`D07`, `D08` & `D14`):** Confirm the vendor payout schedule (e.g., weekly/bi-weekly after return expiry), TDS withholding rates, refund fee rules, and how existing Version 2.0 orders will be closed out separately before switching to the new marketplace.